

Red fox

Vulpes vulpes



Found throughout the northern hemisphere from sea level to 14,750ft (4,500m), in deserts, mountains, forests, farmland, and city centers, red foxes are the most widespread wild canines on the planet. They tailor their behavior and diets to suit highly diverse habitats. Small mammals make up a large part of the red fox's diet, but if rabbits, voles, and mice are scarce, it will eat birds, eggs, earthworms, beetles, and wild fruit such as blackberries.

Opportunistic hunters

Intelligent and territorial, these solitary hunters search for food from dusk until dawn. They are always ready to exploit landfill sites, compost heaps, garbage cans, bird feeders, and other easy sources of food. Excellent vision

and a keen sense of smell give all 44 subspecies of red foxes an edge when it comes to survival, as does a cooperative lifestyle when raising their young. Once a dominant pair establishes a territory, mating occurs in early winter. The vixen digs out a den, or earth, in which she gives birth to four to six cubs around two months later. For the first three weeks, she stays with the cubs, relying on the male to bring her food.

▽ MATED PAIR
A vixen (left) and dog fox (right) race each other through deep snow in early winter, having spotted a potential meal.

↔ 18–36 in (46–91cm)

⚖ 7–31lb (3.2–14 kg)

⊗ Common

🍴 Rabbits, voles, birds, fruit

Arctic, North America, Europe, Asia, and N. Africa

